

# My Challenge Essay

Student: Navon | Assigned: May 25, 2026 | Due: June 03, 2026

## ANSWER KEY -- NOT FOR STUDENT

### REMEMBER

Essay structure: Introduction → Body 1 → Body 2 → Body 3 → Conclusion. Each paragraph needs: a topic sentence + 2–3 details + a closing sentence.

## 1 WHAT YOU ARE WRITING

You are going to write a 4-5 paragraph essay about a challenge you have faced and how you handled it. This could be something that happened at school, in sports, with friends, or at home. Use the steps below to plan it out before you write.

## 2 SEE HOW IT WORKS

**[Topic sentence]** One of the hardest challenges I ever faced was learning to shoot free throws when the pressure was on.

**[Supporting detail 1]** Every time I stepped to the line in a real game, my hands would shake and I would miss -- even though I made them every time in practice.

**[Supporting detail 2]** I started staying after practice every day for two weeks, shooting 50 free throws alone until it felt normal.

**[Closing sentence]** By the end of the season, I was hitting 8 out of 10 from the line, and I learned that pressure gets easier the more you practice in it.

### NOTICE

Notice: The topic sentence tells you WHAT the paragraph is about. The details tell you WHAT HAPPENED. The closing sentence tells you WHAT YOU LEARNED. Every paragraph needs all three.

## 3 PLAN YOUR ESSAY

### PARAGRAPH 1 — INTRODUCTION

What challenge will you write about? Write one sentence introducing it.

**Student names a specific, personal challenge. Look for: real event named clearly (not vague like 'I had a hard time'). One sentence that introduces the challenge without fully explaining it yet.**

#### PARAGRAPH 2 — BODY 1

What happened first? What made it feel hard or scary?

**Student describes the beginning of the challenge. Look for: a specific moment or event, emotional detail, something concrete.**

#### PARAGRAPH 3 — BODY 2

What did you do to handle it? What steps did you take?

**Student explains their response or effort. Look for: active steps taken, not just feelings. Should show agency ('I did X, I tried Y').**

#### PARAGRAPH 4 — BODY 3

What happened because of what you did? Did anything change?

**Student describes the result or outcome. Look for: a change from before to after, connection to their actions in Body 2.**

#### PARAGRAPH 5 — CONCLUSION

What did you learn from this challenge? How did it make you stronger?

**Student reflects on the lesson or growth. Look for: takeaway in their own words, forward-looking language. Flag if it starts with 'In conclusion'.**

### 4 REMINDERS

- Write in complete sentences
- Each paragraph needs a topic sentence, 2-3 details, and a closing sentence
- Do not start your conclusion with "In conclusion"

### BONUS CHALLENGE

Ready for a challenge? Pick your strongest planning note from Section 3 and write the full paragraph here or on the back of this sheet.

*Use the basketball example in Section 2 as your guide: topic sentence first, then two details, then your closing sentence.*

**Bonus answer: Open-ended. Look for: all three elements present (topic sentence, 2+ details, closing sentence). Award bonus for correct structure regardless of topic.**

